TECHNOVA SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.
DATA RETENTION POLICY

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1. Purpose

This Data Retention Policy establishes the principles and minimum requirements TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (“TechNova” or “the Company”) uses to determine how long Company information is retained, where it is retained, how retention is managed, and when information should be securely disposed of.

The objective is to retain information long enough to support legitimate business, operational, contractual, legal, regulatory, security, and historical needs without retaining information indefinitely without justification.

2. Scope

This policy applies to Company information in electronic, physical, structured, unstructured, printed, archived, backed-up, or other forms.

It applies to employees, contractors, consultants, system owners, data owners, administrators, and third parties handling Company information on behalf of TechNova.

3. Retention Principles

- Retain information only for a legitimate and documented purpose.
- Apply retention periods consistently to comparable records.
- Protect retained information according to its sensitivity.
- Preserve information subject to legal, regulatory, contractual, investigation, or litigation requirements.
- Securely dispose of information when retention requirements expire.
- Document exceptions and extended retention where appropriate.
- Ensure retention controls do not undermine required business continuity or recovery capabilities.

4. Data Ownership

Data owners are accountable for identifying the business purpose and appropriate retention requirements for information within their area. Administration and Information Security support governance, control design, and oversight.

5. Data Classification

Retention must be considered alongside information classification. More sensitive information may require stronger access, storage, monitoring, and disposal controls.

- Public
- Internal
- Confidential
- Restricted

6. Record Categories

Category	Examples	Retention Consideration
Corporate records	Policies, approvals, governance records	Business and governance requirements
HR records	Employee lifecycle and employment records	Employment, legal, and business requirements
Finance records	Invoices, expenses, accounting records	Financial, tax, audit, and legal requirements
Operational records	Incidents, assets, service records	Operational, contractual, and risk requirements
Technology records	Logs, tickets, configurations, development records	Security, troubleshooting, audit, and operational requirements
Customer records	Customer-related information and transactions	Contractual, legal, service, and privacy requirements

7. Retention Schedule

The Company should maintain an approved retention schedule identifying record categories, responsible owners, retention periods, and disposal requirements. Where a specific legal, regulatory, contractual, or business requirement applies, that requirement takes precedence over a generic schedule.

8. Default Retention

Where no approved retention period exists, the responsible data owner must assess the purpose, sensitivity, business need, legal obligations, and disposal implications before establishing a reasonable retention period.

Employees must not independently retain information indefinitely simply because storage is available.

9. Retention Period Definition

A retention period should define when the retention clock begins and the event that starts it, such as creation, transaction completion, employee separation, contract termination, or closure of a matter.

10. Legal and Regulatory Requirements

Information subject to legal, regulatory, tax, employment, contractual, or other mandatory retention requirements must be retained for the applicable period.

If requirements conflict, the matter must be escalated to the appropriate Legal, Compliance, Finance, HR, or management function.

11. Contractual Requirements

Customer, supplier, partner, or other agreements may establish retention or deletion requirements. Data owners must consider applicable contractual commitments when defining retention.

12. Personal Information

Personal information should be retained only as long as necessary for the legitimate purpose for which it is processed or for an applicable legal, contractual, or other authorized requirement.

When the purpose ends and no overriding retention requirement exists, information should be securely deleted, anonymized, or otherwise disposed of as appropriate.

13. Sensitive Information

Confidential and Restricted information must remain subject to appropriate access controls throughout its retention period.

- Restrict access by need-to-know.
- Use approved storage.
- Protect information during transfer.
- Apply secure disposal methods.
- Review extended retention periodically.

14. Data Minimization

Teams should avoid collecting or retaining information that is unnecessary for the stated business purpose. Retention is not a substitute for appropriate data minimization.

15. System of Record

Where a record has an identified authoritative system of record, copies maintained in other locations should not be retained indefinitely without a business or legal reason.

16. Duplicate Records

Duplicate copies should be reduced where practical. Business users should avoid maintaining uncontrolled duplicate repositories containing sensitive information.

17. Email Retention

Business email may contain records that require retention. Users should store important business records in approved systems rather than relying solely on individual mailboxes.

18. Messaging and Collaboration Platforms

Information in collaboration tools, chat platforms, shared drives, and similar systems should be retained according to business need and applicable retention requirements.

19. Documents and Files

Documents should be stored in approved repositories with appropriate access and lifecycle controls. Obsolete copies should be removed when they no longer have a legitimate purpose and are not subject to a preservation requirement.

20. Database Retention

Application and database owners must define retention for data stored in production systems, considering application functionality, customer commitments, legal requirements, storage limitations, and operational needs.

21. Application Logs

Logs should be retained for a period appropriate to security, operational, troubleshooting, audit, and compliance requirements. Excessive retention of detailed logs containing personal or sensitive information should be avoided.

22. Security Logs

Security logs may require longer retention than ordinary operational logs to support investigations and security monitoring. Access to security logs must be restricted.

23. Audit Records

Audit records should be retained according to applicable audit, financial, security, contractual, and legal requirements.

24. Financial Records

Finance records must be retained according to applicable accounting, tax, audit, contractual, and legal requirements. Finance is responsible for defining or approving relevant financial retention requirements.

25. HR Records

HR records must be retained according to applicable employment, legal, business, and benefits requirements. Access must be limited to authorized personnel.

26. Recruitment Records

Candidate and recruitment information should be retained only for legitimate recruitment, legal, regulatory, or approved talent-management purposes and according to the applicable retention schedule.

27. Employee Separation Records

Records associated with employee separation should be retained according to applicable HR, financial, legal, contractual, and audit requirements.

28. Expense and Reimbursement Records

Expense claims, receipts, approvals, reimbursement evidence, and related financial records should be retained according to Finance requirements.

29. Procurement Records

Purchase requests, supplier records, approvals, purchase orders, contracts, invoices, and related procurement evidence should be retained according to applicable procurement, financial, contractual, and legal requirements.

30. Incident Records

Incident records should be retained for a period appropriate to operational, security, contractual, legal, audit, and risk-management requirements.

Material security incidents may require preservation of evidence beyond ordinary operational retention.

31. Investigation Records

Records relevant to an investigation must be preserved when directed by authorized personnel. Investigative records should be protected from unauthorized alteration or disclosure.

32. Legal Hold

When Legal or another authorized function places information under a legal hold, ordinary deletion or disposal must be suspended for the affected information.

Personnel must not knowingly delete, alter, conceal, or destroy information subject to a valid preservation instruction.

33. Litigation and Disputes

Potentially relevant information should be preserved when litigation, arbitration, regulatory proceedings, formal disputes, or similar matters are reasonably anticipated and an appropriate hold is issued.

34. Security Investigation Hold

Information Security may require preservation of logs, files, records, or other evidence during a security investigation. Such information must not be deleted according to ordinary schedules until the hold is released.

35. Backup Retention

Backups should have defined retention periods based on recovery objectives, business continuity needs, storage constraints, and risk.

Backups are not intended to become an uncontrolled permanent archive of information that has otherwise reached the end of its approved retention period.

36. Backup Deletion

When information is deleted from primary systems, copies may remain temporarily in backups until the applicable backup cycle expires. Backup restoration processes should not unnecessarily recreate information that should no longer be retained.

37. Cloud Storage

Cloud storage and hosted services must be configured to support applicable retention and deletion requirements. Data owners should understand provider-specific backup and replication behavior.

38. Third-Party Processing

Where a supplier processes Company information, contracts and service arrangements should address appropriate retention, deletion, return, security, and evidence requirements.

39. Supplier Exit

At the end of a supplier relationship, Company information should be returned, securely deleted, or otherwise handled according to contractual requirements and approved instructions.

40. Data Archiving

Archiving may be used when information remains necessary but is no longer required for routine operational use. Archived information remains subject to access, security, and retention requirements.

41. Archive Access

Access to archived information should be restricted and granted only when there is a legitimate business, legal, security, audit, or other authorized need.

42. Disposal Trigger

Disposal should occur when the approved retention period has expired and there is no active legal hold, investigation hold, contractual requirement, or other authorized reason to continue retaining the information.

43. Secure Disposal

- Use approved deletion or destruction methods.
- Securely erase electronic storage where technically appropriate.
- Destroy physical records using approved methods.
- Use authorized disposal providers for sensitive media where required.
- Record disposal evidence when required.

44. Electronic Deletion

Electronic deletion should be performed using mechanisms appropriate to the storage technology and sensitivity of the information. Simply removing a visible file reference may not constitute complete secure disposal in every environment.

45. Physical Records

Paper and other physical records containing confidential or restricted information must be securely destroyed when retention expires.

46. Removable Media

Storage media must be securely erased or destroyed before disposal or reassignment when it contains information requiring protection.

47. Device Disposal

Before technology assets are retired, transferred, or disposed of, Company information must be securely removed in accordance with asset-management and security requirements.

48. Data Destruction Evidence

For high-risk records or regulated information, evidence of deletion or destruction may be maintained to demonstrate that disposal occurred appropriately.

49. Retention Exceptions

Extended retention may be authorized when required for legal, regulatory, contractual, security, audit, business, or other legitimate reasons.

- Document the reason.
- Identify the owner.
- Define the additional period where practical.
- Review the exception periodically.

50. Retention Reviews

Data owners should periodically review whether retained information remains necessary and whether retention schedules continue to reflect actual business processes.

51. Data Owner Responsibilities

- Identify information under their ownership.
- Define legitimate retention needs.
- Apply approved schedules.
- Review exceptions.
- Authorize disposal where required.
- Support audits and investigations.

52. System Owner Responsibilities

- Implement retention controls where technically supported.
- Protect retained information.
- Support deletion and archival processes.
- Document system limitations.
- Escalate retention-control gaps.

53. Employee Responsibilities

- Store records in approved locations.
- Do not retain unnecessary sensitive information.
- Follow retention instructions.
- Do not delete information subject to a hold.

- Report suspected inappropriate retention or disposal.

54. Information Security Responsibilities

Information Security advises on security implications of retention, secure deletion, log retention, evidence preservation, access controls, and information lifecycle risks.

55. Administration Responsibilities

Administration coordinates policy governance, supports records management, and maintains the approved retention framework in collaboration with relevant business owners.

56. Finance Responsibilities

Finance defines or approves retention requirements for financial and accounting records and supports audit or tax-related preservation requirements.

57. HR Responsibilities

HR defines or approves retention requirements for employee and recruitment records and coordinates preservation where employment-related legal or business matters require it.

58. Legal and Regulatory Escalation

Questions involving statutory retention, litigation, legal holds, regulatory requests, or conflicting obligations must be escalated to the appropriate authorized function before disposal.

59. Audit and Compliance

Retention practices may be reviewed through internal audits, security assessments, financial audits, customer reviews, or other compliance activities.

60. Violations

Unauthorized retention, premature deletion, intentional destruction of preserved records, or deliberate circumvention of retention controls may result in corrective or disciplinary action.

Material violations may also create legal, contractual, financial, security, or regulatory consequences.

61. Frequently Asked Questions

Why can't we keep everything forever?

Indefinite retention increases storage, security, privacy, discovery, and operational risk and may conflict with applicable requirements.

Who decides how long a record should be kept?

The responsible data or business owner establishes the need, using the approved retention framework and applicable legal, contractual, regulatory, and business requirements.

What happens when a legal hold is issued?

Normal disposal for affected information must stop until the authorized hold is released.

Do backups need to follow deletion immediately?

Backups may retain information until their approved cycle expires, provided they are appropriately controlled.

Can I delete old files from my laptop?

Only when deletion is consistent with approved retention requirements and the information is not subject to a hold or other preservation requirement.

Should duplicate copies be retained?

Only when there is a legitimate business or legal reason. Uncontrolled duplicates should generally be reduced.

How is sensitive paper information disposed of?

Use an approved secure destruction method rather than ordinary waste disposal.

Does retention mean everyone can access old data?

No. Retained information remains subject to access controls and need-to-know requirements.

What if legal and business requirements conflict?

Escalate to the appropriate authorized function before deleting or extending retention.

What if a system cannot technically delete data as required?

The system owner must document the limitation, assess risk, and work with Information Security and the relevant owner on an appropriate solution.

62. Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Description	Owner	Approval
1.0	01 April 2026	Initial release of Data Retention Policy	Administration / Information Security	Managing Director

63. Related Documents

- Information Security Policy
- Access Control Policy
- Disaster Recovery Policy
- Business Continuity
- Incident Response
- Asset Management
- Employee Handbook
- Leave Policy
- Exit Policy
- Expense Policy
- Reimbursement Policy
- Procurement Policy
- Approval Matrix

END OF DOCUMENT

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